A-A-53542
27 June 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

KNIFE, EAR, STRAIGHT, HOUSE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers a straight ear knife of the House with a sickle-shaped blade, designated as commercial size 1.

Salient characteristics.

Material. The knife shall be manufactured from class 4 type 420 or 440 martensitic corrosion resistant steel of composition in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard F899.

Hardness. The distal 8 millimeters (mm) of the knife shall have a Rockwell Hardness of C50 to C55.

Passivation. The complete knife shall be properly passivated.

Style and design. The knife shall be in accordance with Figure 1. The blade shall be sickle-shaped. Both the inside and the outside edges of the blade shall be sharpened.

Finish. The distal 9 to 14 mm shall have a mirror finish. The remainder of the instrument shall have a satin or matte finish. The finish shall be uniform and free from burrs, pits, scale, rough areas, or grind or tool marks.

Markings. The knife shall be permanently and legibly marked with the manufacturer's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless." In addition, knives of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Workmanship. The knife shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform and free from defects which affect life, utility or appearance

Product Quality Level

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified

Unit. Each (EA). One knife, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures and testing determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties of the item.

Examination. Knives shall be examined to determine compliance with specification requirements.

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Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one knife. Sampling shall be level S-1.

Tests.

Corrosion-resistance tests. Knives shall be tested in accordance with Resistance to Corrosion Tests of ASTM Standard F1089.

Hardness. Rockwell hardness of the blade shall be tested in accordance with the procedure for Rockwell superficial Hardness Tests, using the N-scale diamond penetrator, of ASTM Standard E18. Any of the standard loads may be used. Conversion of Rockwell Superficial Hardness to Rockwell Hardness shall be in accordance with ASTM Standard E-140. The contractor shall have current standardized block verification data on file for Rockwell C and Rockwell 30N scale.

Metric Products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specification, standard, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-00-820-6434	KNIFE, EAR, STRAIGHT; Sickle Shape, House, Size No. 1

Ordering data. Intermediate exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS.

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

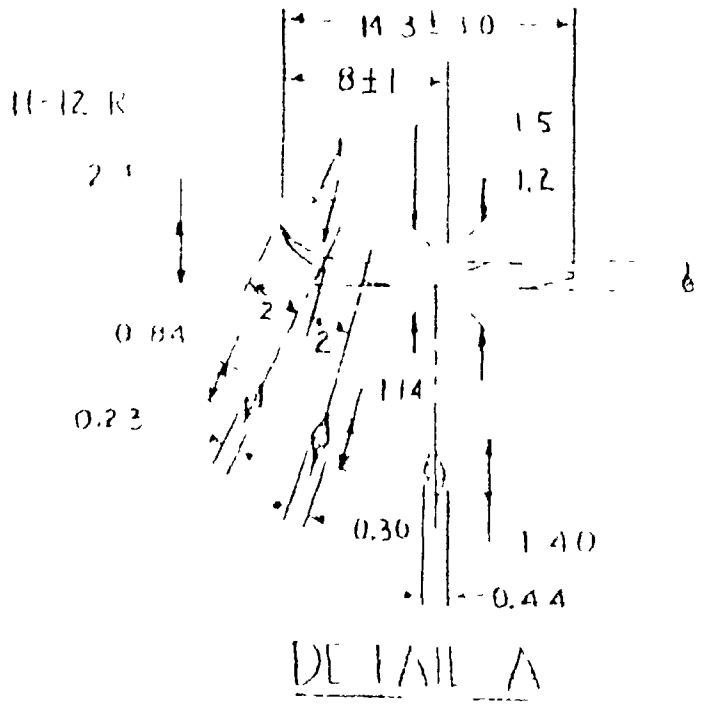
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CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES.

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 46325 Project No. 6515-4537

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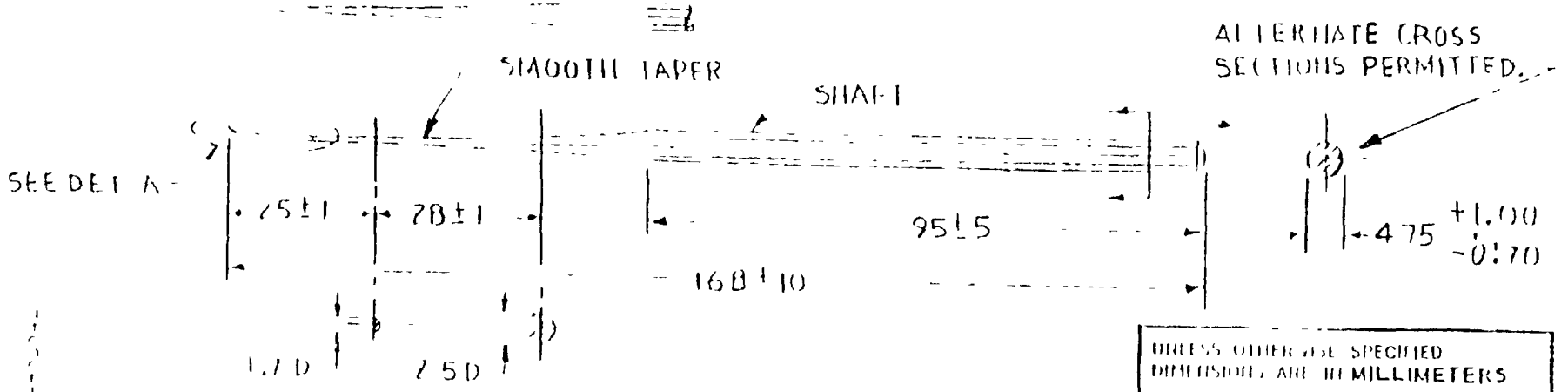


DETAIL A

NOTES

1 SHAFT SHALL HAVE LONGITUDINAL GROOVES OR OTHER MEANS FOR PROVIDING GRIP

2 DETAIL A IS FOR STYLE AND DESIGN ONLY



UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED DIMENSIONS ARE IN MILLIMETERS		
TOLERANCES ON		
X X	X XX	ANGLES
±0.2	±0.20	°

FIGURE 1. KNIFE, EAR (STRAIGHT, HOUSE, SIZE 1)

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53542	KNIFE, EAR (STRAIGHT, HOUSE)

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION (Mark one)
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code)	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER (Specify)

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER (Last, First, MI) – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER (Include Area Code) – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code) – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION (YYMMDD)

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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